



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*sadr̥śaṃ ceṣṭate svasyāḥ prakṛter jñānavān api |
prakṛtiṃ yānti bhūtāni nigrahaḥ kiṃ kariṣyati ||33||
aho dhanyo 'si devarṣe kṛpayā yasya te kṣaṇāt |
nīco 'py utpulako lebhe lubdhako ratim ucyate ||33||*

— Bhagavadgītā-4comm with the commentaries of Śrīdhara, Madhusūdana, Viśvanātha and Baladeva, Chapter 1, Verse 33

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Even the wise act according to their own nature; all beings follow their nature. What can repression accomplish? This question, posed within the Bhagavad Gītā, cuts to the very heart of our understanding of free will and destiny. Arjuna is struggling, paralyzed by the impending battle against his own kin. He seeks guidance, and Krishna, his charioteer and divine advisor, begins to unravel the complexities of dharma, karma, and the very nature of existence.

Krishna points out a fundamental truth: we are all shaped by our inherent nature, our prakriti. This isn't a deterministic sentence condemning us to fixed behaviors. Instead, it highlights the powerful influence of our past experiences, our tendencies, and our ingrained patterns of thought and action. Even someone with vast knowledge, a jñānavān, isn't immune to the pull of their prakriti. They still experience emotions, have preferences, and react to situations based on their unique conditioning.

The verse then asks a pointed question: what good is repression? Simply suppressing your desires or attempting to force yourself into a mold that doesn't fit will ultimately be futile. It's like trying to hold a beach ball underwater – eventually, it will burst to the surface. True transformation doesn't come from rigid control but from understanding and working with your nature, not against it.

In our modern lives, this wisdom is incredibly relevant. We are bombarded with messages telling us who we should be, what we should achieve, and how we should behave. We often try to force ourselves to conform to these external expectations, leading to stress, anxiety, and a sense of disconnect from our authentic selves. Instead, the Bhagavad Gītā encourages us to look inward, to understand our own unique nature, and to cultivate our strengths while gently addressing our weaknesses. It's about aligning our actions with our inner truth, not fighting against it. It's about recognizing that your journey is uniquely yours, shaped by your individual nature, and that true progress comes from embracing that truth.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you fighting against your own nature in some area of your life, and how might you find more harmony by understanding and accepting yourself?